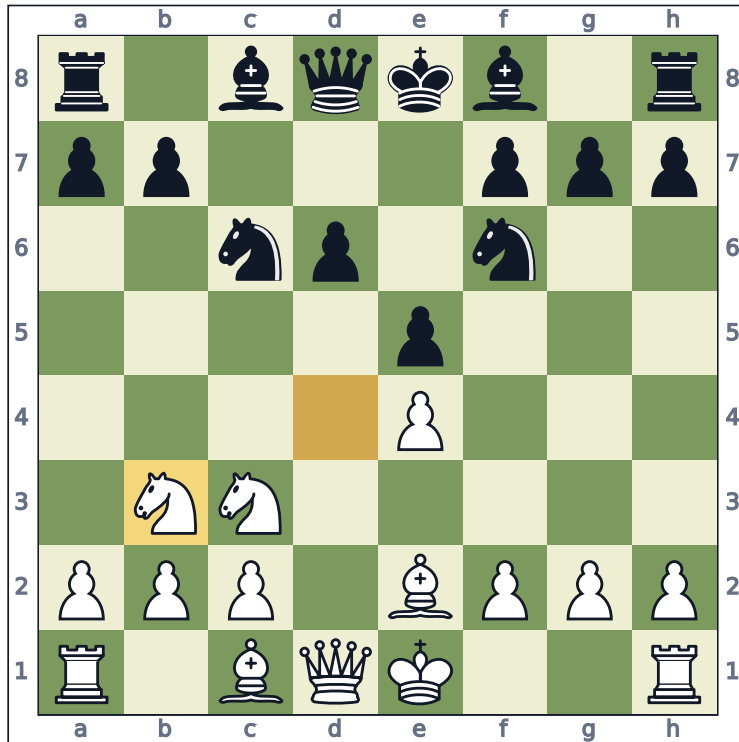


## SICILIAN DEFENSE

# Sicilian Defense

ECO B59 | 1 named line in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

## IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

## ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.21 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

## GAME CHARACTER

Unbalanced and ambitious: both sides usually receive active plans and real winning chances.

## WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B59 covers Sicilian Defense. Black answers 1.e4 with ...c5, creating an asymmetrical center and immediate long-term counterplay. The diagram uses the featured line Sicilian Defense: Boleslavsky Variation.

## DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 d6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3

## UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

# What both sides are trying to achieve

**WHITE'S GOALS**

Develop rapidly, use d4 when appropriate, exploit central space, and decide whether play belongs on the kingside or in the center.

**BLACK'S GOALS**

Use the half-open c-file, pressure the center, prepare ...d5 or ...e5, and generate queenside or central counterplay.

**PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING**

...d5 is often Black's equalizing break. White commonly uses e5, f4-f5, or a central sacrifice to open lines.

**PIECE MAP**

The c-file, d5 square, and development race are central. In opposite-side castling, every tempo matters. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

**WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG**

Memorized attacks fail when the center or castling pattern differs by one move. Recalculate before launching pawns. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

**POSITION SNAPSHOT**

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

**WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?**

A first-rate fighting defense with enormous depth. It is excellent, but specialized variations can be theory-heavy.

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named B59 line

This section preserves all 1 names and defining routes assigned to B59 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

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**Sicilian Defense: Boleslavsky Variation**

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 d6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3